THE GREAT STATES

The great local States of the Middle Eastern constellation are Turkey, Egypt and Iran. The States of the Arabian peninsula, particularly Saudia and the Yemen, may fascinate the readers of the rotogravure sections or excite the interest of oil prospectors. Iraq may set a pattern of aggressive Arab nationalism and of the drift toward authoritarian government in the Arab world. The Lebanon may lead all Arab lands in receptivity to Western influences. These lesser States are, however, too poor, too decentralized, or too small to hope to exert much influence beyond their own frontiers. Economic development in Iraq and Syria may raise them to the level of the Middle East's "big three", but at present they are far behind.

We give below a table of Middle Eastern countries which should be examined in connection with the map in the front end-papers.

Middle Eastern Countries

Country	Area in sq.miles	Population end 1944	Dominant Language	Dominant Religion
Turkey	299,000	19,100,000	Turkish	Islam*
Egypt	386,000	18,100,000	Arabic	Islam
Iran	635,000	15,000,000 or more	Persian	Islam*
Arabian peninsula countries	1,000,000	7,500,000 to 9,000,000	Arabic	Islam
Iraq	175,000	3,000,000 to 3,500,000	Arabic	Islam
Syria	66,000	2,900,000	Arabic	Islam
Palestine	10,400	1,800,000	Arabic, Hebrew	Islam, Judaism
Lebanon	3,900	1,100,000	Arabic	Christianity, Islam
Cyprus	3,600	400,000	Greek, Turkish	Christianity, Islam
Transjordan	34,700	350,000	Arabic	Islam
TOTAL	2,613,600	69,250,000 to 71,250,000		

* But rejected as foundation of nation.

The Middle East is often incorrectly conceived as an area